Key Selection Criteria For Choosing AXI

#	SELECTION CRITERIA	WHAT THE SMT MANUFACTURER SHOULD EVALUATE	WHY IT MATTERS	KEY QUESTIONS TO ASK AXI BRAND
1	AXI technology and inspection method	2D, 2.5D/laminography, 3D, planar CT, full CT; single/multi-angle imaging	Determines how effectively the system can inspect hidden solder joints and overlapping structures	Is it 2D, 3D, laminography, or CT? What type of 3D reconstruction is used?
2	X-ray resolution and image quality	X-ray source focal spot, detector resolution, geometric magnification, image quality, contrast	Determines ability to identify fine-pitch solder joints and small defects	What is the minimum focal spot size? What resolution is achieved at different magnifications? How does resolution vary with board thickness?
3	Inspection speed/ throughput	Cycle time, boards/hour, scan time, number of views, inline takt time	A highly accurate machine is of limited value if it becomes a production bottleneck	What is the actual inspection time for our PCB? What throughput can be achieved with 3D inspection?
4	Defect detection capability	BGA opens/shorts, insufficient/excess solder, bridges, head-in-pillow, missing components, cracks, solder joint geometry	The AXI must detect the specific defects that create quality/reliability problems in the manufacturer's products	Which defects can be detected automatically? What detection capability has been demonstrated on our PCB?
5	Void detection and measurement	Automatic void detection, total void %, individual void size, location, area/volume measurement, reporting	Particularly important for BGAs, QFNs, thermal pads and power electronics where voiding affects reliability and thermal performance	Can the system automatically calculate void percentage? Can it distinguish individual voids? Can limits be configured?
6	AI and automated defect classification	AI-based image analysis, automatic defect classification, false-call reduction, adaptive algorithms	Reduces operator dependency and makes inspection more consistent across products	Is the AI trained on AXI defect data? Can the system distinguish true defects from acceptable variations? What is the false-call rate?
7	Programming and NPI capability	CAD/Gerber/ODB++ import, component library, automatic recognition, automatic inspection-program generation, offline programming	Programming time can become a major cost for EMS and high-mix manufacturers	How long does it take to create a program for a new PCB? Can the program be generated automatically from CAD/Gerber data?
8	PCB and component coverage	Maximum/minimum PCB size, thickness, weight; BGA, QFN, LGA, CSP, PoP, connectors, THT, press-fit, power modules	The machine must accommodate the manufacturer's current and future product mix	What is the maximum board size/weight? Which component/ package types can be inspected? Can double-sided assemblies be inspected?
9	Automation, connectivity and traceability	Inline integration, SMEMA, IPC-CFX, SECS/GEM, MES, barcode/2D code, SPC, data/image storage	Enables the AXI system to become part of an automated smart factory rather than an isolated inspection station	Which factory protocols are supported? Can inspection results be linked to a PCB serial number? Can images and defect data be stored/retrieved?
10	Total cost of ownership and service	Machine price, X-ray tube/detector life, maintenance, calibration, software licences, AMC, spare parts, service response	The lowest purchase price does not necessarily mean the lowest total cost over 5-10 years	What is the expected tube/detector life? Annual maintenance cost? Software/licence cost? Local service availability?

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